

mitsue_email_highreso_intro

Version: v1.2 | Last modified: 2026-05-23

Introduction Email — HIGHRESO Co., Ltd.

Purpose: First-touch introduction to HIGHRESO (株式会社ハイレゾ), inviting an informal exchange about their repurposed-school data center experience and the Mitsue Village project's design choices.

How to approach HIGHRESO

HIGHRESO is the closest operating analogue to the Mitsue project in Japan: they run air-cooled data centers in repurposed school buildings (廃校活用) and publish a PUE target of under 1.1. They are a company at meaningful scale — Mitsue is small, rural, and earlier-stage — so the first contact should be **respectful, learning-oriented, and short**.

Referral context: Joi Ito (伊藤穰一), an advisor to the Mitsue project, identified HIGHRESO as a meaningful potential partner. Naming him in the opening line transforms this from a cold contact into a warm-referral inquiry. Use the referral honestly — Mr. Ito *suggested HIGHRESO's website* as worth studying, not that he made a personal introduction; the email language reflects that exact framing.

Three rules for the first email:

1. **Japanese first.** This is a Japanese company being approached about a Japanese rural project. Japanese-primary signals respect and competence; an English-only first email is a common mis-step.
2. **No partnership ask yet.** Even with a referral, the first email asks for a short introductory conversation only — not a memorandum of understanding, not investment, not a site visit. Save those for later contacts once mutual interest is established.
3. **Lead with the referral, then show you've done your homework.** Reference one specific thing from their site (the PUE <1.1 figure, the school-conversion model, or the Ayagawa Kagawa facility). This signals that the referral was taken seriously and that the email is not generic outreach.

How to find the right contact

- Start with their **website contact form** at <https://highreso.jp/> — this is the official, low-friction route and is normal for first-touch in Japan, including referral-based first-touch
- If Joi Ito is willing to send a direct line (an email to a named contact at HIGHRESO), that is **significantly stronger** than going through the contact form. Worth asking him before sending the form version
- Avoid going directly to executives via LinkedIn InMail for first contact; the contact form is the culturally expected path

What to expect

- A reply may take **1–4 weeks** — Japanese B2B response timing is slower than Western norms; do not follow up before two weeks
- The first reply, if positive, will likely be a brief acknowledgement and a request to schedule a short call (30 min)
- Do not attach the full project documentation to the first email. If they ask for more, send the **English README + Japanese README** and the **introduction A4** — nothing heavier

After the first contact

If they engage, consider — *in this order*: 1. A 30-minute video call to introduce the project and learn from their experience 2. A site visit to one of their facilities (Ayagawa or similar) — only after the call 3. Discussion of any concrete collaboration (technical advisory, knowledge sharing, possibly a referral to their engineering partners)

A formal partnership ask should only come after points 1–3 have established mutual interest.

Draft Email — 日本語版

To: HIGHRESO contact form (<https://highreso.jp/>) — *or* a specific contact name if obtained via warm introduction **Subject:** 廃校活用データセンターに関するご相談 — 御杖村プロジェクトより

株式会社ハイレゾ ご担当者様

このたびは、本プロジェクトの顧問の一人である 伊藤穰一様 より、貴社を「廃校活用型データセンターの運営において、御杖プロジェクトにとって意義ある協力先となり得る企業」としてご紹介いただきましたことから、ご連絡を差し上げる次第です。

オランダ出身で、現在奈良県御杖村において小規模AIデータセンターを核とした地域再生プロジェクトを準備しております、Rob Oudendijk（ロブ・アウデンダイク）と申します。

伊藤様よりお伺いした上で貴社のSDGsに関する取り組みを拝見し、特に**廃校を活用された空冷型データセンター運営**、ならびに**PUE 1.1未満を実現されている設計思想**に深く感銘を受けました。私どもが御杖村の閉校（御杖小学校）を再活用して目指している方向と、まさに同じ方向性を、より大きなスケールで実現されている貴社のご経験から、ぜひ学ばせていただきたく存じます。

御杖村プロジェクトの概要（簡略）：- 奈良県御杖村の閉校舎を活用した、小規模AI／エッジコンピューティング・データセンター（サーバー10～20台規模）
- 個人所有の太陽光発電・バイオマス発電（森林間伐材原料）・EV充電インフラを統合した地産地消型エネルギー設計（蓄電池はフィージビリティスタディで評価）
- 25年スケールの森林再生と林業再活性化を併せて推進 - NPO法人格、地域所有モデル、オープンソース運営を予定

つきましては、もし機会がございましたら、**30分程度のオンライン面談**にて貴社の廃校活用型データセンター運営のご知見を伺えれば誠に幸甚に存じます。本プロジェクトは現在第0段階（地域との対話・設立準備）にあり、貴社のご経験は今後の設計判断において極めて貴重なご示唆となるものと考えております。

ご多忙のところ恐縮ではございますが、ご一考いただけますと幸いです。何卒よろしくお願い申し上げます。

Rob Oudendijk（ロブ・アウデンダイク） 御杖プロジェクト 創設者 YR-Design
代表 / Safecast コア・コントリビューター Email: oudendijk.biz@gmail.com
Project: <https://mitsue.it>

Draft Email — English version (for parallel reference)

To: HIGHRESO contact form, or named contact if obtained **Subject:** Inquiry from the Mitsue Village Project — repurposed-school data center

Dear HIGHRESO Team,

I am writing to introduce the Mitsue Village Project on the recommendation of **Joi Ito (伊藤穰一)**, an advisor to our initiative, who pointed us to HIGHRESO as a company whose work would be a particularly meaningful reference — and potentially a partner — for what we are building in Mitsue.

My name is Rob Oudendijk, a Dutch national currently preparing a rural revitalization project in Mitsue Village (御杖村), Nara Prefecture, centered on a small-scale AI data center.

Following Mr. Ito's suggestion I reviewed your SDGs page and was deeply impressed by your **air-cooled data centers in repurposed schools** and your **published PUE target of under 1.1**. The direction you are realizing at scale is essentially the same direction we are aiming for at a much smaller scale in Mitsue, repurposing the closed Mitsue Elementary School.

Project at a glance: - Small AI / edge-compute data center (~10–20 servers) in a closed elementary school, Mitsue Village, Nara - Integrated locally-generated renewable energy (privately owned solar PV + biomass-electric from forest thinning + EV charging; battery storage subject to feasibility study) - Paired with a 25-year forest restoration and forestry revitalization programme - NPO legal structure, community-owned model, open-source operating playbook

If you would be open to it, I would very much appreciate a **brief 30-minute introductory call** to learn from your experience with school-conversion data centers. The project is currently in Phase 0 (community consultation and founding-team formation), and your insights would be extraordinarily valuable as we make design choices over the coming months.

I am grateful for any consideration you can give to this request, and I fully understand if scheduling is difficult.

With sincere thanks,

Rob Oudendijk Founder, Mitsue Project Founder, YR-Design · Core Contributor,
Safecast Email: oudendijk.biz@gmail.com Project: <https://mitsue.it>

Notes for sending

- **Send Japanese first.** Paste the Japanese block into the contact form; place the English version below it (or omit on the first send — Japanese is sufficient).
- **Subject line:** Use the Japanese subject; if the contact form has a “subject” field accepting only short text, use: 「廃校活用データセンターに関するご相談」
- **Attachments:** None on first contact.
- **Do not mention** funding asks, partnership terms, biomass, or the village mayor on first contact. Save those for later conversations.
- **Follow-up cadence:** If no reply in 14 calendar days, a single polite follow-up (1–2 sentences) is acceptable. After that, leave it.